

Coming Back to the Body

Five minutes. Read it slowly, out loud or in your head.

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Sit down and let your back be tall, your shoulders soft. Close your eyes if that feels right.

Take one slow breath in through your nose ... and let it go through your mouth, longer on the way out.

Notice the weight of your body. The chair or the floor is holding you. You do not have to hold yourself up right now.

Bring your attention to your feet. Not to think about them, just to notice they are there.

Move up slowly ... your legs ... your hips ... your belly rising and falling on its own.

Your chest. Your shoulders, which have probably been up near your ears. Let them drop.

Your jaw. Your forehead. The small space between your eyebrows.

Stay here for a few breaths. Nothing to fix, nothing to solve.

When you are ready, let your eyes open and come back slowly.

Letting the Day Go

For the evening. Read it in bed, with the lights low.

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Lie down and let your body be heavy. Tonight nothing more is being asked of you.

Breathe in slowly ... and out, twice as long. Again.

Think of one thing that happened today that was good, even a small one. Hold it for a moment.

Now think of something that was hard. You do not have to solve it tonight. Just name it and set it down beside you.

The day is over. It is allowed to be over.

Feel your breath slow on its own. Let each exhale take a little more of the day with it.

You have done enough for today. Sleep now.